

Defence presentation outline

Christophe Rouleau-Desrochers

July 30, 2026

1. Content (1 min)

- (a) Intro, chapter 1, chapter 2, conclusion; will last 15-20 minutes.

2. Introduction

- (a) ACC lengthens growing seasons
 - i. Happens through earlier SOS + delayed EOS
 - ii. (Figure): conceptual figure simplified showing SOS and EOS shifts
- (b) GS are longer, but also warmer
 - i. Total annual GDD increases
 - ii. (Figure): conceptual figure with GDD accumulation curve
- (c) SOS + EOS shifts = more GDD, but shifts are assymetric
 - i. Impacts how much GDD is accumulated in the GS
 - ii. SOS shift more, but are cooler
 - iii. EOS shift less, but are warmer
 - iv. (Figure): conceptual figure with showing how much GDD in each season
- (d) SOS + EOS shifts = longer and warmer seasons; should increase growth
 - i. Recent studies failed to find this relationship
 - ii. Important because temperate forest= 40% of global net carbon sink
 - iii. (Figure): TBD
- (e) Question: do trees grow more with longer and warmer seasons?
 - i. Objectives: address GS/growth disconnection using two systems
 - ii. Chapter 1: juvenile trees, 4 species, 4 prov, leaf phenology and tree rings
 - iii. Chapter 2: mature trees, 11 species, leaf phenology and tree rings
 - iv. (Figure): simplified version of thesis overview figure

3. Chapter 1

- (a) Introduction:
 - i. Drought and competition could constrain growth
 - ii. Internal constraints (local adaptation?)
 - iii. Answer if juvenile trees grow more in a drought and competition limited environment
 - iv. (Figure):
- (b) Methods: common garden set up
 - i. Trees grown from seeds, 4 species, 4 provenances
 - ii. Phenology for 3 years
 - iii. Calendar and thermal season from leafout to budset
 - iv. Growth via tree rings
 - v. (Figure): map and common garden photo
- (c) Methods: stats?
 - i. Bayes hierarchical model

- ii. 4 different season predictors
 - iii. (Figure): model equation and conceptual figure showing predictors?
 - (d) R/D: thermal > calendar
 - i. Species grew more with warmer seasons than longer calendar season
 - ii. Because warmer is a better predictor of growth
 - iii. Thermal season weights growth days while calendar assumes a stable growth rate throughout the season
 - iv. (Figure): 2 pannel mu plot for GDD and GSL
 - (e) R/D: EOS > SOS;
 - i. EOS temperature higher temperature than SOS
 - ii. EOS delayed less, but contribution is higher because days are warmer
 - iii. Suggests looking more at EOS than SOS
 - iv. (Figure): 2 pannel mu plot for EOS and SOS AND conceptual figure showing GDD differences at EOS and SOS
 - (f) R/D: No provenance effect;
 - i. In this small climatic gradient, no evidence of local adaptation on growth
 - ii. (Figure): provenance mu plot
4. Chapter 2
- (a) Introduction: life history strategies could inform tree growth responses
 - i. Fast vs slower growing species
 - ii. Diffuse vs ring porous species
 - iii. Carbon allocation to storage = blur annual growth response to thermal and calendar seasons
 - (b) Methods: citizen science leaf phenology at the Arboretum
 - i. Growth via tree rings
 - ii. Leaf phenology
 - iii. 11 angiosperm deciduous species spanning different growth strategies and wood porousness
 - iv. (Figure): Arboretum map AND core scans
 - (c) Methods: stats
 - i. Hierarchical model for the 4 predictors
 - ii. Leafout and leaf coloring as SOS and EOS
 - iii. Previous year model
 - iv. (Figure): TBD
 - (d) R/D: weak response across species across current year predictors
 - i. Ball decreased growth: southernmost range reduction in future ACC
 - ii. Tiam: grew less with earlier SOS despite being fast growing
 - iii. No consistent trend across life history strategies or wood porousness
 - iv. (Figure): mu plots 4 facet
 - (e) R/D: 2 species responded to previous year thermal season
 - i. Ball increase growth with previous yr condition
 - ii. Bnig grew more only when considering previous yr condition
 - iii. Reveals importance of carbon allocation to storage for mature trees; blur responses
 - iv. (Figure): previous year conditions mu plot
5. Conclusion and future work
- (a) Chapter 1 and 2
 - i. Chapter 1: warmer seasons for juvenile trees = good for forest regeneration and range expansion
 - ii. Chapter 2: no effect of longer and warmer seasons: probably bad for forest carbon
 - iii. (Figure): simplified version of thesis overview figure
 - (b) Fuelinex
 - i. Observational studies have limits
 - ii. Fuelinex will look at carry over effect of longer seasons with relative effect of each season.
 - iii. (Figure): some random photo of the experiment